

(Copy and pasted from private chat)

We didn't feel like chai would fit as well with this world, and I have an idea for aeolus- generally she's an orphan in a big city who made her way to a tavern, learned what she could there, and I'm down to adapt where she's at based on what makes sense, but generally just, she spends a lot of time at a place that lots of different people would come through

What I'm thinking as far as guild is that the mage guild also says it's an intelligence agency, and I could totally see her meeting someone who's involved with that side of it, who gets her involved with it

Cause I don't see her with a lot of the guilds, but I could totally see her joining that specifically for the intelligence side of things

(New stuff)

I'm talking to maya too- as far as the awakening for the affinity goes. She had an idea of luck as an affinity, and honestly it would fit quite well with how I have played the mortal version of aeolus before. She loves her card games (and other games, but cards are her favorite) and would have spent a lot of time playing them from a young age, and usually winning (and frustrating the people around her because of it). Of course, there is strategy involved in cards (and other games), at least in some games, some more than others, and she has that, but there is a luck aspect too. I'm wondering if she may have been sort of *extra* good at, winning more than she statistically should, but with no evidence that could ever show her cheating. She also had a lot of luck-based abilities when I played her in dnd the first time, and I could see it being really interesting for her to have that as an affinity.

Ofc, the wind is the obvious choice too, and I think is also pretty easy to justify- she didn't really have a home for the first part of her life. There could have been a storm that could have killed her (and maya mentioned the idea that it could have actually either killed or separated her from her parents, too- whether they died or not, it could easily be the reason she's an orphan), but she survived as a result of her affinity.

Maya also mentioned the potential for a double affinity, especially if I'm from the continent where the double affinities are more common. I don't need to have a double affinity by any means unless you think it'd make sense, but given both options feel like they could fit into her backstory pretty easily, I figured I'd mention it anyway, because it does seem like an interesting concept that could fit well. Though something else that occurred to me... I know it says we don't know why the double affinities are more common on Thyrelun, but you also did say that affinities are hereditary. I wonder if that has anything to do with it. If it dates back far, and for whatever reason people started off with more affinities there, and therefore it was passed down. And if that is anywhere near the truth, and if she was made to have a double affinity, I wonder if her parents could be an interesting knife for me to give you (in the sense of the knife theory of backstories). If they survived, they could have been in some capacity very powerful/very important, which could be interesting to incorporate in the future depending on what you have planned

All I ultimately care much about in terms of location for her to be from is that she's from a very cosmopolitan city, and it does kind of sound like the city on that continent would fit too, if it's the convergence of so much magic? If it's a dangerous city maybe it wouldn't be as popular for people to visit, but I'd imagine the magic would balance that out to an extent too? I don't know,

ig that'd be something for you to answer about. So maybe I'll pause here until I've given you a chance to read this haha

(Also, for the record- I need to write something out for the sake of having a bit more detail, but I think that since we are going with the luck affinity, her initial awakening would probably be the first time she learned cards

She'd have been taught by some random person in the tavern she's from, they would've asked her if she's ever played and she'd have said no but asked to learn, and then maybe lost the first round or two, but once she got the hang of it she'd have won, and I feel like that would be a fitting place for the awakening to happen)

(Unless this is enough detail and it's all good, but I can try to get more detail in there if you would like)

Backstory/Affinity

General backstory: she's from overshire, and was orphaned when she was too young to remember, under circumstances that she also doesn't remember. (We can discuss the details of that if we decide to use it, but we don't have to necessarily, that's something I usually have as a sort of a collaboration that comes out naturally if it ends up being in the campaign.) Around the age of 8, she found her way to a tavern, where she ended up living, and still lives to this day, paying to stay with the money she makes mainly from her card games.

She's good at cards in part out of natural ability, but also is helped out by her affinity. Her awakening was the first time she was taught to play cards. She lost the first time, did a bit better the second, and that was when her luck affinity awakened. I think the vibe I kind of want it to have is sort of a playing the odds kind of thing? In this particular case she would've won the third game entirely because of her affinity setting the odds in her favor, literal beginner's luck, and then practiced a ton with cards to get better with them without using the affinity as much as she can. She kind of goes back and forth on how much she uses it to win though, mostly depending on how much she respects her opponent as a player and wants to give them a fair chance. I think the affinity could also be used to give them better odds in combat down the line? I don't know how exactly you want to adapt that, but I think something like that is the vibe that I want for the affinity.

To add to the backstory and her time in the tavern, she would've also picked up other skills here and there from the people who she meets there. Other games, maybe a couple weapons (I've mostly given her a bow and arrow before, so that would likely be her main weapon that she's spent time with, though she could've also been taught a bit about other things, but I doubt she'd be super proficient with a lot of them), or just other random skills that likely wouldn't really have an impact on the campaign. Like I said though, as she discovered how solid she was at gambling, she'd end up playing mostly men who expected to be able to win against her easily and then couldn't, which would give her an easy way to keep paying to stay at the tavern.

I think that's about everything that I can think of? Let me know if there's anything else you need to know though.